

# Zhichao Wang

*Curriculum Vitae*

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<https://zhichao-w.github.io>

## EDUCATION

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University of California San Diego, USA

*PhD candidate in Mathematics, 2019-present*

- Advisors: Prof. Ioana Dumitriu and Prof. Todd Kemp

Texas A&M University, College Station, USA

*MSc. in Mathematics, 2017-2019*

- Advisors: Prof. Michael Anshelevich

Texas A&M University, College Station, USA

*Exchange Program, 2016-2017*

Beihang University, Beijing, China

*BSc. in Mathematics and Applied Mathematics, 2013-2017*

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

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- High-dimensional Probability · Random Matrix Theory and its Applications · Free Probability Theory
- Deep Learning Theory · Feature Learning · Kernel Methods · Random Feature Regression
- High-Dimensional Statistics · Asymptotic Statistics

## PUBLICATIONS AND PREPRINTS

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- **High-Dimensional Asymptotics of Feature Learning in the Early Phase of Neural Network Training** (with Jimmy Ba, Murat A. Erdogdu, Taiji Suzuki, Denny Wu, and Greg Yang), in preparation.
- **Overparameterized random feature regression with nearly orthogonal data** (with Yizhe Zhu), Accepted by AISTATS 2023.
- **Spectral evolution and invariance in linear-width neural networks** (with Andrew Engel, Anand Sarwate, Ioana Dumitriu, Tony Chiang), submitted.
- **High-dimensional Asymptotics of Feature Learning: How One Gradient Step Improves the Representation** (with Jimmy Ba, Murat A. Erdogdu, Taiji Suzuki, Denny Wu, and Greg Yang), Accepted by NeurIPS 2022.
- **Deformed semicircle law and concentration of nonlinear random matrices for ultra-wide neural networks** (with Yizhe Zhu), submitted.
- **Tree convolution for probability distributions with unbounded support** (with Ethan Davis and David Jekel), Latin American Journal of Probability and Mathematics Statistics 18.2 (2021), pp. 1585-1623.
- **Spectra of the Conjugate Kernel and Neural Tangent Kernel for linear-width neural networks** (with Zhou Fan), Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), 2020, *Oral Presentation*.
- **Principal components in linear mixed models with general bulk** (with Zhou Fan and Yi Sun), The Annals of Statistics, 49.3 (2021), pp. 1489-1513.
- **Higher variations for free Lévy processes** (with Michael Anshelevich), Studia Math. 252 (2020), pp. 49-81.
- **Convergence of the Powers of Free Triangular Arrays to Higher Variations of Free Lévy Processes**, Master's thesis, Texas A & M University, *available electronically*.

## WORK EXPERIENCES

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| <b>Internship at Pacific Northwest National Laboratory</b>               | <i>06/2021- 09/2022</i> |
| Advisor: Tony Chiang. Deep learning research and software development.   |                         |
| <b>Teaching Assistant at Math Department of UC San Diego</b>             | <i>09/2019-12/2021</i>  |
| MATH 10B, MATH 3C, MATH 10C, MATH 180A, and MATH 280BC.                  |                         |
| <b>Teaching Assistant at Math Department of Texas A&amp;M University</b> | <i>08/2018-07/2019</i>  |
| MATH 251, MATH 308 and MATH 220.                                         |                         |
| <b>Grader of Math Department at Texas A&amp;M University</b>             | <i>01/2017-05/2018</i>  |
| MATH 467, MATH 411 and MATH 152.                                         |                         |
| <b>Internship at AMSS, Chinese Academy of Sciences</b>                   | <i>07/2016-08/2016</i>  |
| Advisor: Prof. Feimin Huang, AMSS, Chinese Academy of Sciences           |                         |
| <b>Mentor at Math Department, Beihang University</b>                     | <i>10/2014-07/2015</i>  |

## HONORS AND AWARDS

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| <i>2019</i>       | Math Fellowship, UCSD, USA                                                        |
| <i>2017</i>       | Math Fellowship, TAMU, USA                                                        |
| <i>2016, 2017</i> | Study Abroad Scholarships, Beihang University, China                              |
| <i>2016</i>       | Meritorious Winner of MCM/ICM Contest, USA                                        |
| <i>2016</i>       | Second Prize in the 26th Fengru Cup Competition of Academic Research Works, China |
| <i>2015, 2016</i> | Hua Luogeng Scholarships, AMSS, Chinese Academy of Sciences                       |
| <i>2014, 2015</i> | Huatong Scholarships of SMSS, Beihang University, China                           |
| <i>2014, 2015</i> | Scholarships of Academic Performance, Beihang University, China                   |
| <i>2014</i>       | First Prize in College Students Physics Contest in Beijing, China                 |
| <i>2013</i>       | Freshman Scholarship, Beihang University, China                                   |

## TALKS

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|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>06/2022</i> | RMMC Summer School at University of Wyoming.                                                                         |
| <i>03/2022</i> | Combinatorics and Probability Seminar at UC Irvine.                                                                  |
| <i>12/2021</i> | Frontier Probability Days 2021, at Las Vegas.                                                                        |
| <i>09/2021</i> | Universality and Integrability in Random Matrix Theory and Interacting Particle Systems Workshop, at MSRI (virtual). |
| <i>03/2021</i> | Machine Learning Seminar, at Pacific Northwest National Laboratory (virtual).                                        |
| <i>12/2020</i> | Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) virtual oral presentation.                                           |
| <i>03/2020</i> | Student Probability Seminar, at UCSD.                                                                                |
| <i>11/2019</i> | Student Probability Seminar, at UCSD.                                                                                |
| <i>05/2017</i> | Capstone Project Presentation, TAMU.                                                                                 |
| <i>04/2016</i> | Complex Dynamic Systems Seminar, Beihang.                                                                            |

## SKILLS

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|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Language</i> | Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)                                                    |
| <i>Software</i> | Python, MATLAB, L <sup>A</sup> T <sub>E</sub> X, Tensorflow, Keras, PyTorch, JAX, C++ |

## PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

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Journal reviewer: Annals of Statistics, Canadian Journal of Mathematics.  
Conference reviewer: AISTATS '22, AISTATS '23.